

Doc / PPT / PDF Converter and Merger

How to start it and how to use it — a quick reference.

1. What it does

Drop in any mix of Word documents, slide decks and PDFs, put them in the order you want, and get back a single merged PDF. Anything that is not already a PDF is converted first by LibreOffice; PDFs pass straight through untouched.

Group	Extensions	Handled by
Documents	.doc, .docx, .odt, .rtf, .txt	LibreOffice Writer
Presentations	.ppt, .pptx, .odp	LibreOffice Impress
PDF	.pdf	merged directly, no conversion

2. One-time setup

You only need to do this once on a machine.

Install Node.js 18 or newer and LibreOffice. LibreOffice does every non-PDF conversion, so without it only PDF-to-PDF merging works. On Windows the default install path is detected automatically:

```
C:\Program Files\LibreOffice\program\soffice.exe
```

Then install the project dependencies:

```
cd "C:\Users\LENOVO\Downloads\Ppt_to_pdf_converter_and_merger"
npm install
npm --prefix frontend install
```

3. Starting it — the easy way

From the project folder, run the launcher:

```
cd "C:\Users\LENOVO\Downloads\Ppt_to_pdf_converter_and_merger"
.\start-merger.bat
```

Then open <http://localhost:10001> in your browser.

The launcher checks what is already running, starts only what is missing, waits for both services to answer, and prints [ACTIVE] when ready. Running it twice is harmless — if everything is already up it just reports and exits.

Service	Port	What it is
Frontend	10001	The web page you actually open
Backend	10002	Conversion + merge API (/process)

You only ever open port 10001

The frontend forwards its /process calls to the backend for you, so port 10002 never needs to be opened directly in a browser.

4. Starting it manually from a terminal

Useful when you want to watch the logs, or when the launcher is not available. This needs two terminals, both in the project folder.

Terminal 1 — backend

```
# PowerShell
$env:PORT = "10002"; node server.js

# Command Prompt (cmd.exe)
set PORT=10002 && node server.js
```

Wait for Server running at <http://localhost:10002>.

Terminal 2 — frontend

```
npm --prefix frontend run dev -- --port 10001
```

Then open <http://localhost:10001>.

5. Alternative: one port, no dev server

This builds the frontend once and lets the Node backend serve it, so everything runs on a single port. Slower to start, but only one terminal:

```
npm start
```

Then open <http://localhost:10002>. Set the PORT environment variable first if you want a different port.

6. Using the app

Step	What you do
1. Add files	Drag files onto the drop zone, or click it to browse. Any mix of the supported types is fine.
2. Set the order	The Merge Queue shows a numbered card per file. The number is the position that file will take in the final PDF.
3. Merge	Click Convert + Merge. The merged PDF downloads automatically when it is done.

Four ways to reorder

Method	How
Drag a card	Grab anywhere on a card and drag it to a new slot. The other cards move aside to show where it will land.
Arrow buttons	Hover a card and use the left / right chevrons to nudge it one place. Disabled at the ends.
Sort A–Z	Sorts the whole queue by filename, numerically aware so file2 comes before file10.
Reverse	Flips the current order end to end.

Remove a single file with the × in its top-right corner, or empty the whole queue with Clear Queue.

7. Stopping it

Press Ctrl+C in each terminal window, or close the two windows the launcher opened. To force both ports free from PowerShell:

```
Get-NetTCPConnection -LocalPort 10001,10002 -State Listen |
ForEach-Object { Stop-Process -Id $_.OwningProcess -Force }
```

8. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause and fix
Port 10002 is already in use	It is already running. Just open http://localhost:10001 .

Symptom	Cause and fix
Page will not load at all	The frontend did not start. Check the frontend terminal for an npm error, and confirm you ran <code>npm --prefix frontend install</code> .
LibreOffice is required	LibreOffice is missing or not on PATH. Install it, then restart the backend so it picks up the new PATH.
Merge seems to hang	Expect roughly 10–15 seconds per non-PDF file — that is LibreOffice starting up. The progress bar deliberately holds near 92% rather than claiming it is finished early.
Upload rejected	The file type is not in the supported list in section 1. Unsupported files are skipped with a toast rather than failing the whole batch.
Merged PDF is in the wrong order	The card numbers, not the order you added the files, decide the output. Check the numbers before clicking Convert + Merge.

Where files go

Uploads and intermediate conversions live in a temporary folder and are deleted as soon as the merge finishes or fails. Only the merged PDF reaches your Downloads folder. Nothing is sent off your machine — both services run locally.